

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 566

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Cristy Dunn upon receiving the Arts Leadership Award from the Tennessee Arts Commission.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to commend those exemplary citizens who, through their abiding commitment to excellence, have made significant contributions to the arts and brought pride and acclaim to the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Mountain City native Cristy Dunn, a professional artist, teacher, and community leader who has been named a recipient of the Arts Leadership Award from the Tennessee Arts Commission as part of the 2025 Tennessee Governor's Arts Awards; and

WHEREAS, established by the Tennessee Arts Commission in 1971, the Governor's Arts Awards recognize extraordinary artistic and cultural contributions and achievements by individuals or organizations with State, regional, and national impact; the awards are the State's highest honor in the arts; and

WHEREAS, the Executive Director of the Johnson County Center for the Arts, Ms. Dunn has emerged as a steadfast rural arts leader, elevating regional music and history, fostering community pride, and enhancing her community as a destination for public art and cultural tourism; and

WHEREAS, Cristy Dunn's deep connection to her Appalachian heritage is evident in every mural, class, and cultural initiative she leads, including the Mountain City's Mural Mile, a walking tour featuring seventeen murals depicting songs, artists, and themes tied to Johnson County's rich musical legacy; and

WHEREAS, in 2015, she co-founded the Long Journey Home Musical Heritage Festival, an annual celebration of Appalachian arts and music, and in 2016 helped launch and now

presides over the Johnson County Junior Appalachian Musicians program, nurturing the next generation's connection to traditional music; and

WHEREAS, in 2017, Ms. Dunn, together with a handful of dedicated citizens, founded the Johnson County Center for the Arts; as its executive director, she has transformed the center into a thriving regional cultural hub that supports over one hundred local artists, offers classes, and serves as an inclusive gathering place; and

WHEREAS, after rapid growth, Cristy Dunn led the recent charge to expand the Center for the Arts into a larger and more central Main Street location, while retaining the original building as a frame shop, pottery studio, and gathering space; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Dunn's quiet but effective leadership is matched by her hands-on commitment, from curating exhibits to installing floors, demonstrating her unwavering dedication; and

WHEREAS, she also lends her service to the wider arts community as a board member of Tennesseans for the Arts and is a nationally recognized oil painter whose work has been exhibited from Blowing Rock, North Carolina, to New York City's Salmagundi Club and is even archived on the moon as part of the Lunar Codex; and

WHEREAS, for her many contributions to the arts, Cristy Dunn is wholly deserving of this prestigious honor and special recognition; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Cristy Dunn upon receiving the Arts Leadership Award from the Tennessee Arts Commission as part of the 2025 Tennessee Governor's Arts Awards, commend her extraordinary contributions to the arts, and extend to her our best wishes for every continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.